# Paper Two

**General.**

"This paper will test students' knowledge of and response to a range of texts"

(DES English Syllabus, 7.4 p 20)

**N.B. RESPONDING TO DRAMATIC TEXTS**

In attempting the questions set on dramatic texts, candidates are free to support the points they make by reference to performances of the texts that they have seen.

**MARKING RESPONSES TO MORE THAN ONE SINGLE TEXT**

Please consult your advising examiner in the event that a candidate responds to a question or questions on more than one single text.

**N.B. Rubrics 2024 – SECTION I SINGLE TEXT**

**Candidates are required to answer any two of the four questions set on each of the Single Texts.**

**<u>Each question carries 30 marks.</u>**

# Section I Single Text (60 Marks)

## C PHILADELPHIA, HERE I COME! – Brian Friel

Answer **any two** of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

**1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)**

Expect candidates to choose a complicated relationship from the text giving at least one reason why this relationship is complicated. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Gar & S.B O'Donnell – Lack of communication between both causes issues; Public Gar & Private Gar – Private Gar struggles with the need to reconcile his true feelings about leaving for Philadelphia; *Gar & Kate Doogan* – Gar unable to fully express his feelings for Kate and to ask Senator Doogan for her hand in marriage.

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| **Combined Criteria ex 10** | **P + C = 6** | **L + M = 4** |

**(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)**

Expect candidates to explain whether the characters in their chosen relationship were happy, unhappy or a combination of both. Allow for a mixed response. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Gar & S.B O'Donnell; deeply unhappy, S.B never recollects important moments that Gar is talking to him about and results in frustration; Gar & Kate Doogan – combination of both; Kate appears happy with relationship but Gar's failure to take responsibility leads to an unhappy ending for both; Public Gar & Private Gar unhappy; Private Gar's inner turmoil and sense of alienation from his public self-results in unhappiness and despair, etc.

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| **Combined Criteria ex 10** | **P + C = 6** | **L + M = 4** |

**(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)**

Expect candidates to explain what they consider to be the most valuable lesson they have learned from their study of the complicated relationship above. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text

**Indicative Material:** Communication is key; have no regrets in life; take responsibility for important decisions; don't wait to express yourself; faraway fields aren't always greener; the importance of tolerance; man's inadequacies; social injustice, etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 10 | P + C = 6 | L + M = 4 |
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**2. Your local drama group has just attended a production of Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having watched the play. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text**.

Expect candidates to give a presentation to their local drama group about the lasting thoughts and feelings they were left with having watched the play. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text

**Indicative Material:** Thoughts; importance of communication in relationships, the reality of emigration; life in a rural community, etc. Feelings; Sadness with Gar leaving his father behind in Ballybeg/confusion – will Gar actually get on the plane?; frustration with the main characters; anger with society and what it has created, etc.

| Discrete Criteria ex 30 | P = 9 | C = 9 | L = 9 | M = 3 |
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**3. Brian Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.**
**Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.**

Expect candidates to agree or disagree with the view that the play is a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live. Allow for a broad range of responses to the task. Candidates may agree/disagree or both. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.
**Indicative Material:** Agree: relationship communication issues; all characters struggle with maintaining fully functioning relationships; desire for independence and freedom; Gar desires his autonomy/ Loneliness; Ballybeg is an isolated and rural town; a world where people will let you down – Madge and the baby, etc.

| Discrete Criteria ex 30 | P = 9 | C = 9 | L = 9 | M = 3 |
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**4. To celebrate Drama Week, English classes in your school are staging scenes from the plays they are studying. Your class is to stage a scene from Brian Friel's play, *Philadelphia, Here I Come!*. Identify the scene that your class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why you think an audience would be interested in watching this scene. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.**

Expect candidates to identify the scene that their class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why they think their audience will enjoy this particular scene. Allow for a loose interpretation of 'scene'. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.

**Indicative Material:** Gar visiting Senator Doogan's house – highlights his lack of courage; Master Boyle visit signifies what life will be like for Gar if he stays in Ballybeg; Aunt Lizzy's visit – what Gar is letting himself in for; S.B with the newspaper upside down – symbolic of their relationship; Final scene – unsure if Gar actually departs, cliff-hanger etc.

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| **Discrete Criteria ex 30** | **P = 9** | **C = 9** | **L = 9** | **M = 3** |

## E THE CRUCIBLE – Arthur Miller

Answer **any two** of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

**1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Miller's play, *The Crucible*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)**

Expect candidates to choose a complicated relationship from the text giving at least one reason why this relationship is complicated. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** John & Elizabeth Proctor – John's affair with Abigail Williams strains their marriage/trust needs to be rebuilt; Abigail Williams & John Proctor – Abigail's obsession with John and her jealousy of Elizabeth causes friction between both of them; religious/societal pressures help to create the complicated relationships, etc.

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| **Combined Criteria ex 10** | **P + C = 6** | **L + M = 4** |

**(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)**

Expect candidates to explain whether the characters in their chosen relationship were happy, unhappy or a combination of both. Allow for a mixed response. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** John & Elizabeth Proctor – combination of both; Elizabeth is cold with John over his infidelity however during the witch trials they demonstrate deep love and reconcile; Abigail Williams & John Proctor – unhappy; Abigail can't have John to herself and his rejection of her leads to tragic consequences. etc.

**(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)**

Expect candidates to explain what they consider to be the most valuable lesson they have learned from their study of the complicated relationship above. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text

**Indicative Material:** The importance of fidelity, be open and transparent, true love does exist, the strains that can be exerted on relationships; no relationship is perfect – there will always be ups and downs, the strength of any relationship can be sorely tested by unexpected circumstances, etc.

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| **Combined Criteria ex 10** | **P + C = 6** | **L + M = 4** |

**2. Your local drama group has just attended a production of Arthur Miller's play, *The Crucible.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having watched the play. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.**

Expect candidates to give a presentation to their local drama group about the lasting thoughts and feelings they were left with having watched the play. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.

**Indicative Material:** Thoughts; the danger of fake news, hysteria/faith in a God/the abuse of power and corruption in society, etc. Feelings: anger – how innocent people were condemned to death on lies/Sympathy – for the likes of John & Elizabeth Proctor/reflective on their own role in society, the positive and negative role religion can play; depressed by how easily manipulated people can be into believing lies, etc.

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| **Discrete Criteria ex 30** | **P = 9** | **C = 9** | **L = 9** | **M = 3** |

**3. Miller's play, *The Crucible,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.**
**Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.**

Expect candidates to agree or disagree with the view that the play is a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live. Allow for a broad range of

responses to the task. Candidates may agree/disagree or both. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.

**Indicative Material:** Agree: Mass hysteria and fear – false accusations labelled against characters/pressure to conform; characters face pressure to conform to the strict moral codes of puritan society/ betrayal; lack of trust in the Salem inhabitants of each other; Being true to one's own beliefs; being an individual against the herd mentality, etc.

| Discrete Criteria ex 30 | P = 9 | C = 9 | L = 9 | M = 3 |
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**4. To celebrate Drama Week, English classes in your school are staging scenes from the plays they are studying. Your class is to stage a scene from Arthur Miller's play, *The Crucible*. Identify the scene that your class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why you think an audience would be interested in watching this scene. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text.**

Expect candidates to identify the scene that their class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why they think their audience will enjoy this particular scene. Allow for a loose interpretation of 'scene'. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.

**Indicative Material:** *opening scene in Reverend Parris's House* – filled with tension and suspense/meet Abigail Williams for first time/sense of foreshadowing, etc. *The Trial Scene in the Courtroom* – intense conversations with dramatic emotional outbursts/how the fate of the accused plays out/performance of Abigail Williams would engage audience here, etc. *Final meeting between John & Elizabeth Proctor* – audience moved in heart-breaking scene/Proctor's inspiring moral courage/brings closure to the drama, etc.

| Discrete Criteria ex 30 | P = 9 | C = 9 | L = 9 | M = 3 |
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## G **HAMLET** – William Shakespeare

Answer **any two** of the following four questions. Each question carries 30 marks.

**1. (a) Identify a complicated relationship in Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet*. Explain one reason why this relationship is complicated. (10)**

Expect candidates to choose a complicated relationship from the text giving at least one reason why this relationship is complicated. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Hamlet & Gertrude – Hamlet feels betrayed over Gertrude's marriage to Claudius; Hamlet & Claudius – Hamlet suspects Claudius murdered his father and seeks revenge; Hamlet & Ophelia – Hamlet's feigned madness and cruel treatment of Ophelia leaves her confused and heartbroken; Hamlet and his father – complicated by the task Hamlet is set, etc.

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| **Combined Criteria ex 10** | **P + C = 6** | **L + M = 4** |

**(b) Are the characters in the complicated relationship you identified in part (a) happy, unhappy or a combination of both? Explain your response with reference to the text. (10)**

Expect candidates to explain whether the characters in their chosen relationship were happy, unhappy or a combination of both. Allow for a mixed response. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Hamlet & Gertrude – unhappy; her "o'er hasty marriage" results in Hamlet feeling disgust towards his mother which causes tension; Hamlet & Claudius – unhappy; trust has been eroded creating a constant unease between both characters; Hamlet & Ophelia – unhappy; Hamlet's cruel treatment of Ophelia leads to her untimely death, etc

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| **Combined Criteria ex 10** | **P + C = 6** | **L + M = 4** |

**(c) What is the most valuable lesson you have learned from your study of the complicated relationship you have identified? Support your response with reference to the text. (10)**

Expect candidates to explain what they consider to be the most valuable lesson they have learned from their study of the complicated relationship above. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text

**Indicative Material:** corrupting influence of power, consequences of inaction, fragility of human existence, complexity of human nature, jealousy destroys relationships; relationships can be unhealthy challenging, destructive; relationships can evolve and change significantly over time and due to unique circumstances etc.

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| **Combined Criteria ex 10** | **P + C = 6** | **L + M = 4** |

**2. Your local drama group has just attended a production of Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet.* You have been asked to give a presentation to the group about the lasting thoughts and feelings you were left with having watched the play. Write the text of the presentation you would give. Support your response with reference to the text.**

Expect candidates to give a presentation to their local drama group about the lasting thoughts and feelings they were left with having watched the play. Consideration should be given to the

quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.
**Indicative Material**: Thoughts: destructive power of revenge/ the treatment of women in society/mental health issues/ appearance v's reality, etc. Feelings: compassion – the reality of human suffering and loss; loyalty; the importance of justice; appearance vs reality; frustration with Hamlet's inaction; sadness with the loss of life, etc.

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| **Discrete Criteria ex 30** | **P = 9** | **C = 9** | **L = 9** | **M = 3** |

**3. Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet,* has been described as a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live.**
**Do you agree or disagree with this view? Support your response with reference to at least one character in the text.**

Expect candidates to agree or disagree with the view that the play is a fascinating exploration of the challenges faced by characters in the world in which they live. Allow for a broad range of responses to the task. Candidates may agree/disagree or both. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.
**Indicative Material:** Agree: Betrayal and deception – Hamlet has to deal with the fallout of his father's murder/treatment of women – Gertrude and Ophelia are treated unfairly/corruption – Claudius uses and abuses his corrupt influence on other characters for his own gain, challenge of being true to yourself; of facing the difficulties of life; of deciding on matters of justice; facing mortality. etc. Disagree: boring; too slow moving; people wouldn't react like this; they would act, etc.

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| **Discrete Criteria ex 30** | **P = 9** | **C = 9** | **L = 9** | **M = 3** |

**4. To celebrate Drama Week, English classes in your school are staging scenes from the plays they are studying. Your class is to stage a scene from Shakespeare's play, *Hamlet.* Identify the scene that your class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why you think your audience would be interested in watching this scene. Your explanation should demonstrate your knowledge and understanding of the text**.

Expect candidates to Identify the scene that their class has chosen to stage and explain three reasons why they think their audience will enjoy this particular scene. Allow for a loose interpretation of 'scene'. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided, the use of suitable reference to the text and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Candidates must support their response with reference to the text.

**Indicative Material:** *Hamlet meets the Ghost* – creates intrigue and suspense/provides background details to plot, etc. *The play within a play scene* – dramatic recreation of his father's murder/will Hamlet take revenge? etc. *The Closet Scene* – his treatment of his mother/he kills Polonius…what are the consequences for him? etc. *Duel Scene* – will Claudius' plan work? Truly shocking ending that will grip an audience, etc

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| **Discrete Criteria ex 30** | **P = 9** | **C = 9** | **L = 9** | **P = 3** |

## SECTION II THE COMPARATIVE STUDY (70 MARKS)

**General**

In all answers to questions in this section, candidates may compare **and/or** contrast, i.e. address similarities **and/or** differences in both content and style of their chosen texts.
In shaping their responses to the questions on the Comparative Study it is expected that candidates will be involved in some/all of the following kinds of activities:

- Description/analysis of the text(s) in relation to the modes for comparison
- Making general observations about texts in relation to one another
- Making connections between similar aspects of texts
- Recognising differences between texts
- Showing that similarities/differences need to be qualified
- Demonstrating awareness of themselves as readers, their reactions/responses/involvement

Expect a wide variety of approaches both in the patterns of discussion and the manner of illustration.
Some questions invite candidates to refer to **one/more key moment(s)** from the texts.
The purpose of this is to allow the candidates to ground their responses in specific moments without feeling that they must range over the entire text(s). However, do not expect that all the illustrative references in an answer will come from the key moment(s). Candidates may offer appropriate illustrative reference from any part of the text(s).

**Important Note**

In answering questions on the Comparative Study, candidates are not permitted to:
(i) re-use the Single Text already answered on
(ii) use a text not included on the prescribed list of texts for the year in which the examination takes place
(iii) use more than one film.
In this section:

- If an invalid text, as outlined above, is used in a question that demands reference to one text only, no mark is awarded.
- If an invalid text, as outlined above, is used as part of a two-part answer (Comparative), <u>mark according to the Marking Scheme taking due account of the quality of the comparative element</u>. Deduct half of the marks awarded.

**N.B.** Questions use the word **text** to refer to all the different kinds of texts available for study on this course. Questions use the word **character** to refer to both real people and fictional characters in texts.

Candidates must answer **ONE** question from **either A** – Hero, Heroine, Villain **B** – Theme or **C** – Social Setting.

## A HERO, HEROINE, VILLAIN

**1. (a) (i) Name one text on your comparative course and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Use one or more key moment(s) to show how an action or a decision taken by this character had a significant impact on another character. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)**

Candidates should name one of their comparative texts, identify a hero, heroine or villain they studied in it. Candidates should use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how an action or a decision taken by this character had a significant impact on another character. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

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| **Combined Criteria ex 15** | **P + C = 9** | **L + M = 6** |

**(ii) Name another comparative text you have studied and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Use one or more key moment(s) to show how an action or a decision taken by this character had a significant impact on another character. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)**

Candidates should name another comparative text, and identify a hero, heroine or villain they studied in it. Candidates should use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how an action or a decision taken by this character had a significant impact on another character. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

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| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |

**(b) Identify a hero, heroine or villain from each of at least two texts on your comparative course. Compare the extent to which you found these characters inspiring. Support your response with reference to your chosen texts. (40)**

Candidates should identify a hero, heroine or villain from each of at least two texts on their comparative course and compare the extent to which they found these characters inspiring. Answers should be supported with reference to at least two comparative texts. Consideration should be given to the quality of the comparative writing – the emphasis is on identifying similarities and/or differences. This requires the candidate to make comparison(s) throughout the response. Pay attention to all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Use code C to indicate where relevant similarities and/or differences are given.

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| Discrete Criteria ex 40 | P = 12 | C = 12 | L = 12 | M = 4 |

**OR**

**2. (a) (i) Name one text you studied as part of your comparative course and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Describe a key moment when your chosen character behaved in a way that led to an important turning point in that text. Explain why this was an important turning point. Support your response with reference to the text. (15)**

Candidates should name one of their comparative texts, identify a hero, heroine or villain they studied in it. Candidates should use one key moment to demonstrate how their chosen character behaved in a way that led to an important turning point and explain why this was an important turning point. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

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| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |

**(ii) Name another text you studied as part of your comparative course and identify a hero, heroine or villain in it. Describe a key moment when your chosen character behaved in a way that led to an important turning point in that text. Explain why this was an important turning point. Support your explanation with reference to the text. (15)**

Candidates should name another comparative text, and identify a hero, heroine or villain they studied in it. Candidates should use one key moment to demonstrate how their chosen character behaved in a way that led to an important turning point and explain why this was an important turning point. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

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| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |

**(b) Identify a hero, heroine or villain from each of at least two texts on your comparative course. Compare the extent to which you found these characters inspiring. Support your response with reference to your chosen texts. (40)**

Candidates should identify a hero, heroine or villain from each of at least two texts on their comparative course and compare the extent to which they found these characters inspiring. Answers should be supported with reference to at least two comparative texts. Consideration should be given to the quality of the comparative writing – the emphasis is on identifying similarities and/or differences. This requires the candidate to make comparison(s) throughout the response. Pay attention to all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Use code C to indicate where relevant similarities and/or differences are given.

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Discrete Criteria ex 40 | P = 12 | C = 12 | L = 12 | M = 4 |

## B THEME

**1. (a) (i) Name one text on your comparative course and identify a theme you studied in it. Identify a main character whose treatment of other characters in the text helped you to explore your chosen theme. Use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how the main character's treatment of other characters helped you to explore your chosen theme. Support your answer with reference to your chosen text. (15)**

Candidates should name one comparative text and identify a theme from it. They should identify a main character whose treatment of other characters in the text helped them to explore their chosen theme. Candidates should use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how the main character's treatment of other characters helped them to explore their chosen theme. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment

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| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |

**(ii) Name another text on your comparative course. In relation to the same theme discussed in part (a) (i) above, identify a main character whose treatment of other characters in this text helped you to explore your chosen theme. Use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how the main character's treatment of other characters helped you to explore your chosen theme. Support your answer with reference to your chosen text. (15)**

Candidates should name another comparative text. They should identify a main character whose treatment of other characters in the text helped them to explore the same theme discussed in (a) above. Candidates should use one or more key moment(s) to demonstrate how the main character's treatment of other characters helped them to explore their chosen theme. Answers should be supported by reference to the text. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment

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| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |

**(b) Compare the extent to which the exploration of the same theme you discussed in part (a), left you feeling positive or negative, in each of at least two texts on your comparative course. Support your answer with reference to your chosen texts. (40)**

In relation to at least two comparative texts they have studied, candidates should compare how the theme they discussed in part (a) left them feeling positive or negative. Answers should be supported with reference to at least two comparative texts. Consideration should be given to the quality of the comparative writing – the emphasis is on identifying similarities and/or differences. This requires the candidate to make comparison(s) throughout their response. Consideration should be given to all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment. Use code C to indicate where relevant similarities and/or differences are given.

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| Discrete Criteria ex 40 | P = 12 | C = 12 | L = 12 | M = 4 |

## C SOCIAL SETTING

**1. (a) (i) Name one of the comparative texts you have studied and identify the aspect of the social setting that you found most memorable. Use one or more key moments(s) to help explain why you found this aspect of the social setting so memorable. Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)**

Candidates should name one comparative text they have studied and identify an aspect of the social setting that they found most memorable. Candidates should use one or more key moments to help explain why they found this aspect of social setting so memorable. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

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| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |

**(ii) Name another comparative text you have studied and identify the aspect of the social setting that you found most memorable. Use one or more key moment(s) to help explain why you found this aspect of the social setting so memorable.**
**Support your answer with reference to the text. (15)**

Candidates should name another comparative text they have studied and identify an aspect of the social setting that they found most memorable. Candidates should use one or more key moments to help explain why they found this aspect of social setting so memorable. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation provided and to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

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| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |

**(b) Identify an aspect of the social setting in each of at least two comparative texts you have studied. Compare the extent to which these aspects of the social setting changed or remained the same over time in your chosen texts. You may refer to the same aspect or different aspects of social setting in each of your chosen texts.**
**Support your answer with reference to your chosen texts. (40)**

In relation to at least two comparative texts they have studied candidates should compare the extent to which their chosen aspect of social setting changed or remained the same over time. They may refer to the same aspect or different aspects. Answers should be supported with reference to at least two comparative texts. Consideration should be given to the quality of the comparative writing – the emphasis is on identifying similarities and/or differences. This requires the candidate to make comparison(s) throughout their response. Consideration should be given to all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.
Use code C to indicate where relevant similarities and/or differences are given.

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|---|---|---|---|---|
| Discrete Criteria ex 40 | P = 12 | C = 12 | L = 12 | M = 4 |

# SECTION III POETRY (70 MARKS)

**General.**
"Students should be able to…read poetry conscious of its specific mode of using language as an artistic medium." (DES English Syllabus, 4.5.1)

Note that responding to the unseen poem is an exercise in aesthetic reading. It is especially important, in assessing the responses of the candidates, to guard against the temptation to assume a 'correct' reading of the poem.

Reward the candidates' awareness of the patterned nature of the language of poetry, its imagery, its sensuous qualities, its suggestiveness etc.

Candidates must answer the questions on the Unseen Poem **and** the questions on **one** of the Prescribed Poems – A, B, C, D, E, F.

**UNSEEN POEM** (20 marks)

**1. The poet in the above poem is effective in appealing to our senses. Identify the place where, in your view, the poet is most effective in appealing to our senses. Explain your choice with reference to the poem. (10)**

Candidates should explain if they think the poet is effective in appealing to the reader's senses. Answers should be supported by reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Yes: appeals to the 5 senses; smell/sight 'skinshine smell'/ hearing 'I heard an owl'/ touch ' made bread'/ taste 'soft froth of juice'/ visual imagery 'mountain', etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 10 | P + C = 6 | L + M = 4 |
|---|---|---|

**2. From reading the above poem, which of the following word or words do you think accurately describes the tone or mood of this poem?**

**Hopeful Reflective Challenging**

**Support your explanation with reference to the poem. (10)**

Candidates should explain which word or words accurately describes the tone of the poem. Answers should be supported by reference to the poem. Candidates are not required to treat all aspects of the question. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Hopeful; poem deals with all the 'good' things in life/ language is positive and energetic 'good things will be waiting'/ reinforcement of personal pronoun 'I', etc. Reflective; focuses on positive activities one does during the day/ examines the amazing world around us, etc. Challenging: makes us question our attitude and outlook on life/ encourages us to focus on the positive things in our life rather than the negative.

| Combined Criteria ex 10 | P + C = 6 | L + M = 4 |
|---|---|---|

# PRESCRIBED POETRY (50 marks)

**Candidates must answer on ONE of the following poems: (A – F)**

## A STREET - **Eiléan** Ní Chulleanáin

**1. (a) Based on your reading of the above poem, what impression do you form of the butcher's daughter? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)**

Candidates should outline what impression they form of the butcher's daughter. Allow for a wide range of responses. Answers should be supported by reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Violent – carrying a knife/Good fashion sense – wearing "white trousers"/Mysterious – what is she up to/Precise – "shoes paired", impersonal, sinister, magnetic, exotic yet mundane; threatening, etc.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Combined Criteria ex 15** | **P + C = 9** | **L + M = 6** |

**(b) Do you think Ní Chulleanáin has chosen a good title for this poem? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)**

Candidates should explain whether or not, in their opinion, Ní Chulleanáin has chosen a good title for this poem. Answers should be supported with reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Yes: sense of mystery about the title reflected in the poem/all the action happens on or near the street; links with everyday experience. No: vague title, title misleading and confusing as not connected to subject matter, doesn't help to explain the poem, etc.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Combined Criteria ex 15** | **P + C = 9** | **L + M = 6** |

## 2. Answer ONE of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

**(i) Eiléan Ní Chulleanáin makes readers use their imaginations when engaging with her poem *"Street".* Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response.**

Candidates should explain whether or not, in their opinion, Ní Chulleanáin's, in her poem "Street", invites readers to use their imaginations when engaging with the poem. Answers should be supported with reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Agree: visualise all the rich imagery contained in the poem 'red cresent' 'slanting lane', need to try and figure out what is going on with the 'butcher's daughter' etc. Disagree: easy to understand what is happening in poem so no, etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 20 | P + C = 12 | L + M = 8 |
|---|---|---|

**OR**

**(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem?**
**Thought-provoking Menacing Confusing**
**Explain your response with reference to the poem.**

Candidates should explain which word or words they would choose from the list to describe the poem. Answers should be supported by reference to the poem. Candidates are not required to treat aspects of the question equally. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material**: Thought-provoking: no background information given, more questions than answers, etc.
Menacing: blood, danger, 'Dangling a knife' horror movie feel to poem, etc.
Confusing: no idea of context, where or when poem is set, where is the girl going in her bare feet? etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 20 | P + C = 12 | L + M = 8 |
|---|---|---|

**OR**

**(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Ni Chuilleanáin in her poem, "Street" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem.**

Expect candidates to write a talk for a radio programme where they explain why the language used by Ni Chuilleanáin in her poem, "Street" appeals to them. Answers should be supported with reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** simple and accessible 'He fell in love with the butcher's daughter', suggestive verbs 'dangling – stared', precise sounding words 'He stared at the dark shining drops', poet controls language i.e. last four lines – information coming slowly in exact phrases, etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 20 | P + C = 12 | L + M = 8 |
|---|---|---|

## D BUYING WINKLES – Paula Meehan

**1. (a) Based on your reading of the above poem, what impression do you form of Paula Meehan's neighbourhood? Support your answer with reference to the poem. (15)**

Candidates should outline what impression they form of Paula Meehan's neighbourhood. Allow for a wide range of responses. Answers should be supported by reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material**: Poor, rundown 'bulb had blown'/ Dangerous – 'strange men'/ Friendly – Meehan would 'wave up to the women at sills', tight-knit; industrious; magical/mysterious; friendly, protective, etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |
|---|---|---|

**(b) Do you think that Paula Meehan enjoyed her childhood years? Support your explanation with reference to the poem. (15)**

Candidates should explain whether or not, in their opinion, Paula Meehan enjoyed her childhood years. Answers should be supported with reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Yes: Even in the rain, Meehan was 'happy' collecting the winkles/magical experience eating the winkles 'brought the sea to me'/happy memories returning 'proudly home' with her haul of winkles, etc. No: she was poor and wanted a better life 'I envied each soul in the hot interior', the winkles show the hardship people endured – foraging for survival, etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 15 | P + C = 9 | L + M = 6 |
|---|---|---|

## 2. Answer ONE of the following: [Each part carries 20 marks]

**(i) Paula Meehan makes readers use their senses to help them engage with her poem "Buying Winkles". Do you agree? Explain your answer using the poem to support your response.**

Candidates should explain whether or not, in their opinion, Meehan, in her poem "Buying Winkles", makes readers use their sense when engaging with the poem. Answers should be supported with reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Agree: clever use of sibilance – we can hear the sibilant 'spare me sixpence and say'/ contrast of light & darkness – 'tenement' stairs are in darkness, poet hopes that the 'moon' or 'stars' will light the way, etc. Disagree: everyday mundane boring images that fail to excite the sense, etc.

| Combined Criteria ex 20 | P + C = 12 | L + M = 8 |
|---|---|---|

**OR**

**(ii) Which of the following word or words would you choose to describe this poem?**
**Nostalgic Colourful Realistic**
**Explain your response with reference to the poem.**

Candidates should explain which word or words they would choose from the list to describe the poem. Answers should be supported by reference to the poem. Candidates are not required to treat aspects of the question equally. Consideration should be given to the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment

**Indicative Material**: Nostalgic: Meehan reflects back on growing up in the tenements and going on the quest for buying winkles, etc. Colourful: poem is bursting with colour, energy and life 'glisten blue' 'orange-crate' 'golden mirrors', etc. Realistic: life was difficult for the people of inner-city Dublin. Buying winkles gave the family a taste of the exotic and an escape from the boredom of routine life, etc.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Combined Criteria ex 20** | **P + C = 12** | **L + M = 8** |

**OR**

**(iii) You have been invited to contribute to a radio programme called 'Poetry Craft', which discusses popular poets and their work. You have been asked to explain why the language used by Meehan in her poem, "Buying Winkles" appeals to you. Write the text of the contribution you would make. Support your response with reference to the poem.**

Expect candidates to write a talk for a radio programme where they explain why the language used by Meehan in her poem "Buying Winkles" appeals to them. Answers should be supported with reference to the poem. Consideration should be given to the quality of the explanation and the quality of all aspects of the response with regard to the Criteria for Assessment.

**Indicative Material:** Great use of rhyme 'say' 'way'/alliteration 'the bulb had blown'/familiar place names 'Gardiner Street'/lyrical effect of language 'My mother would spare me sixpence and say' which has a nursery rhyme effect, clever use of colloquial language, etc.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Combined Criteria ex 20** | **P + C = 12** | **L + M = 8** |

**APPENDIX 1**

## LEAVING CERTIFICATE ENGLISH CRITERIA FOR ASSESSMENT.

| | | | Percentage Weighting |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Clarity of Purpose** | Engagement with the set task | e.g. relevance, focus, originality, freshness, evidence of critical literacy (where appropriate), clear aim, understanding of genre | 30 |
| **Coherence of Delivery** | Ability to sustain the response over the entire answer | Where appropriate: continuity of argument, sequencing, management of ideas, choice of reference, use of examples, engagement with texts, control of register and shape, creative modelling | 30 |
| **Efficiency of Language use** | Management and control of language to achieve clear communication | e.g. vocabulary, syntax, sentence patterns, punctuation appropriate to the register, use of lively interesting phrasing, energy, style, fluency appropriate to the task | 30 |
| **Accuracy of Mechanics** | Spelling<br><br>Grammar | e.g. appropriate levels of accuracy in spelling<br><br>grammatical patterns appropriate to the register | 10 |

| | |
|---|---|
| **Clarity of Purpose: 30%** | **Coherence of Delivery: 30%** |
| **Efficiency of Language Use: 30%** | **Accuracy of Mechanics: 10%** |

**APPENDIX 2**

**Discrete Criteria:**

| **100 marks** | **01** | **02** | **03** | **O4** | **05** | **06** | **07** | **08** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 100 - 90 | 89 - 80 | 79 - 70 | 69 - 60 | 59 - 50 | 49- 40 | 39 - 30 | 29 - 0 |
| 30% | 30 - 27 | 24 | 21 | 18 | 15 | 12 | 9 | 8 - 0 |
| 10% | 10 - 9 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 - 0 |

| **50 marks** | **O1** | **O2** | **03** | **O4** | **O5** | **O6** | **O7** | **O8** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 50 - 45 | 44 - 40 | 39 - 35 | 34 - 30 | 29 - 25 | 24 - 20 | 19 - 15 | 14 - 0 |
| 30% | 15 -14 | 12 | 11 | 9 | 8 | 6 | 5 | 4 - 0 |
| 10% | 5 | 4 | 3 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 1 - 0 |

| **40 marks** | **O1** | **O2** | **O3** | **O4** | **O5** | **O6** | **O7** | **O8** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 40 - 36 | 35 - 32 | 31 - 28 | 27 - 24 | 23 - 20 | 19 - 16 | 15 - 12 | 11 - 0 |
| 30% | 12 - 11 | 10 | 9 | 8 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 - 0 |
| 10% | 4 | 3 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 - 0 |

| **30 marks** | **01** | **O2** | **O3** | **O4** | **O5** | **O6** | **O7** | **O8** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 30 - 27 | 26 - 24 | 23 - 21 | 20 - 18 | 17 - 15 | 14 - 12 | 11 - 9 | 8 - 0 |
| 30% | 9 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 - 0 |
| 10% | 3 | 2 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 | 0 |

**Combined Criteria**

| | **O1** | **O2** | **O3** | **O4** | **O5** | **O6** | **O7** | **O8** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **20 marks** | 20 - 18 | 16 | 14 | 12 | 10 | 8 | 6 | 5 - 0 |
| **P & C 12** | 12 - 11 | 10 | 9 | 8 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 - 0 |
| **L & M 8** | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 3 | 2 - 0 |
| | **O1** | **O2** | **O3** | **O4** | **O5** | **O6** | **O7** | **O8** |
| **15 marks** | 15 - 14 | 12 | 11 | 9 | 8 | 6 | 5 | 4 - 0 |
| **P & C 9** | 9 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 - 0 |
| **L & M 6** | 6 | 5 | 4 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 1- 0 |

| | **O1** | **O2** | **O3** | **O4** | **O5** | **O6** | **O7** | **O8** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **10 marks** | 10 - 9 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 - 0 |
| **P & C 6** | 6 | 5 | 4 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 1 - 0 |
| **L & M 4** | 4 | 3 | 3 | 2 | 2 | 1 | 1 | 1 - 0 |

**APPENDIX 3**

Reasonable Accommodations.

Candidates presenting for examinations with the aid of a scribe or a recording device or a spell-check enabled word processor and other candidates who have been granted an exemption in accordance with the State Examination Commission's RACE manual will have all parts of their examination in English assessed except spelling and written punctuation elements.

A modified marking scheme will apply as follows:

| | |
|---|---|
| Clarity of Purpose | 30% (to be assessed) |
| Coherence of Delivery | 30% (to be assessed) |
| Efficiency of Language (including grammar) | 30% (to be assessed) |
| Spelling and Written Punctuation | 10% (not to be assessed) |

This means, in effect, that these candidates will be assessed in all questions out of 90% of the marks available for the question.

Marks awarded for each question on Paper I and Paper II will be transferred to the script cover grid of each paper and totalled. As these totals were arrived at on the basis of a 90% application of the available marks, a mark that can be converted into a grade is arrived at by dividing the total for each paper by 9, and adding these marks to the original total in order to achieve a grand total for that paper.

**Example:**

| | |
|---|---|
| Total for Paper I | = 125 |
| Divide by 9 | = 13 |
| Grand Total | = 138 |

Fractions of marks are to be **rounded down** to the nearest whole mark **Note:**

In using the Combined Criteria the following will apply:

Questions valued at 20 marks are assessed out of 18 marks
Questions valued at 15 marks are assessed out of 13 marks
Questions valued at 10 marks are assessed out of 9 marks.